

RIVETRELAY CONTRACTOR OPERATIONS TOOLKIT

Scope and Change-Order Control Pack

Practical, editable operating materials for specialty contractors. Built for disciplined follow-through; no outcome or legal guarantee is implied.

RivetRelay

Version 1.0.0 · AI-assisted original work · Licensed for one purchasing business

Scope and Change-Order Control Pack

- Product ID: RR-CO-001
- Version: 1.0.0
- Initial test price: \$49
- Working brand: RivetRelay (provisional; not cleared for publication)

What this pack does

This pack helps a contractor distinguish original scope from a proposed change, document cost and schedule impact, capture a decision reference, and hand an approved change to billing. It is an operational record system, not a substitute for a contract, legal review, or locally required change-order form.

Included source files

- `START_HERE.md` : quick start and operating rhythm.
- `IMPLEMENTATION_GUIDE.md` : setup, responsibilities, controls, and exception handling.
- `SCOPE_AND_CHANGE_ORDER_PLAYBOOK.md` : baseline worksheet, field notice, decision record, scripts, and checklists.
- `change_order_tracker_template.csv` : clean import/source table.
- `change_order_tracker_fictional_example.csv` : six fully populated fictional records.
- `change_order_fields_and_formulas.csv` : field rules, validation, and formulas.
- `VERSION_LICENSE_SUPPORT.md` : version, use terms, limitations, support, and AI disclosure.
- `CLAIMS_INVENTORY.csv` : bounded claims linked to artifacts.

The populated fictional tracker is a static example snapshot with `Control_Date` set to 2026-07-11. The packaged workbook recalculates pending-day and control values only from the explicit control date and current verified row values.

Thirty-minute start

1. Identify the approved agreement, scope, drawings, selections, and allowances for each active project.
2. Assign one change-control owner and one field escalation route.
3. Open the delivered tracker workbook, retain its protected formula columns, and set the verified `Control_Date` ; use the CSV template only for a controlled import.
4. Give field personnel the four-step rule: observe, make safe if necessary, document, and escalate.
5. Create a record for every proposed deviation from the current approved scope.
6. Do not mark a change `APPROVED` without an acceptable decision reference under the business's contract and local requirements.
7. Reconcile approved changes with billing at least weekly.

Core status flow

IDENTIFIED → PRICING → PENDING_CUSTOMER → APPROVED or DECLINED → SCHEDULED → COMPLETED → BILLED

Use `ON_HOLD` when a required fact, decision, authority, or safety resolution is missing. Never move a record forward merely to make the queue look current.

Daily field-to-office handoff

- Field identifies the condition and preserves a factual photo or note reference.
- Office links the original-scope reference and confirms whether the condition is actually a change.
- Estimator records cost and schedule impact from an approved calculation.
- Authorized person issues the proposal or required form.
- Customer decision is recorded with its evidence reference.
- Operations schedules only authorized work, subject to documented safety/emergency rules.
- Billing reconciles approved value to an invoice reference.

Weekly owner review

- Unpriced identified changes.
- Proposed work being performed without an approval reference.
- Approved changes not yet scheduled.
- Completed changes not yet billed.
- Declined changes that still appear in field scope.
- Records with uncertain contract or decision authority.

The pack reports only what users record. Missing approvals, values, dates, or evidence must remain visible as exceptions.

IMPLEMENTATION GUIDE

Implementation guide

Before operational use

Have the business's qualified contract or legal reviewer decide what constitutes authorization, who may approve, whether electronic acceptance is permitted, what notices are required, how taxes are handled, and which emergency-work rules apply. Configure this pack to those decisions; do not treat the included language as jurisdiction-specific legal terms.

Roles

Role	Minimum responsibility
Field lead	Stops scope drift, records observed conditions, and escalates.
Change-control owner	Determines status, maintains records, and routes decisions.
Estimator	Produces supported cost and schedule impact.
Authorized issuer	Sends the approved proposal or contract-required form.
Billing owner	Reconciles approved and completed changes to invoices.
Business owner	Resolves authority, safety, contract, and customer disputes.

Setup sequence

1. Define the scope baseline

For each active project, assign one `Original_Scope_Ref` that points to the current approved agreement and scope. Record later approved revisions separately. Do not copy confidential agreements into the tracker; use the approved document-system reference.

2. Choose controlled values

- `Change_Status` : IDENTIFIED, PRICING, PENDING_CUSTOMER, APPROVED, DECLINED, ON_HOLD, SCHEDULED, COMPLETED, BILLED, VOID.
- `Requested_By` : CUSTOMER, CONTRACTOR, DESIGNER, AUTHORITY, SITE_CONDITION, OTHER.
- `Approval_State` : NOT_REQUESTED, REQUESTED, APPROVED, DECLINED, EXPIRED, DISPUTED, NOT_APPLICABLE.
- `Billing_Status` : NOT_READY, READY, INVOICED, PARTIALLY_PAID, PAID, DISPUTED, CREDITED.
- `Safety_Class` : ROUTINE, SAFETY_HOLD, EMERGENCY_MAKE_SAFE.

Only the business's approved policy may define when `EMERGENCY_MAKE_SAFE` work may proceed. Record the safety action separately from authorization for permanent changed work.

3. Build the tracker

Use the delivered workbook for normal operation. It contains the `ChangeOrders` Excel table, controlled-value validation, explicit date and currency formats, and protected calculated columns. The CSV template and `change_order_fields_and_formulas.csv` remain the editable import and implementation specification.

4. Connect supporting records

Every change should point to:

- project record;
- current original-scope reference;
- observed-condition evidence;
- estimate or pricing workpaper;
- issued change proposal;
- approval/decline evidence;
- completion evidence when performed;
- invoice reference when billed.

A filename by itself may be ambiguous. Use a stable reference that the team can resolve in its approved system.

5. Pilot on one active project

Reconcile all open field questions on one project. Compare each tracker status to the underlying evidence. Correct the process before expanding to the rest of the portfolio.

Decision rules

Is it a change?

1. State the observed condition without blame or inference.
2. Compare it with the current approved scope.
3. If the work is already included, route it as base-scope work, not a change.
4. If uncertain, set `ON_HOLD` and obtain an authorized interpretation.
5. If it is different, create the change record before work proceeds, except for documented make-safe action.

Is it approved?

`Approval_State=APPROVED` requires:

- the decision maker's authority is acceptable under the business's rules;
- scope, value, schedule impact, and relevant terms match the issued proposal;
- evidence of the decision is stored and referenced;
- the record is not expired, superseded, or disputed.

A verbal conversation may be useful context, but the pack does not define it as binding approval.

Quality checks

- Unique change-order ID per project.
- Original-scope reference present.
- Observed condition and proposed change are distinct.
- Cost inputs trace to an approved workpaper.
- Schedule impact is stated as days or explicitly unknown.
- Tax treatment is reviewed, not guessed.
- Approval evidence matches the version being scheduled.
- Completion does not automatically imply approval.
- Billing references only approved, performed work under the local process.

Exception handling

Exception	Response
Field work started without record	Stop non-safety work where appropriate, document actual status, and escalate. Do not backdate approval.
Customer asks for an immediate change	Document the request and use the approved expedited process.
Amount changes after proposal	Issue a new revision; preserve the superseded record.
Schedule impact unknown	State <code>UNKNOWN</code> and hold unsupported schedule claims.
Approval disputed	Set <code>DISPUTED</code> or <code>ON_HOLD</code> , preserve evidence, and escalate.
Emergency condition	Make safe under approved policy, record the action, and separate it from permanent repair authorization.
Completed but not billed	Reconcile completion and billing evidence; do not manufacture an invoice date.

Maintenance

Review open changes at the same time each week. Reconcile tracker totals to project and billing systems without treating the tracker as the accounting ledger. Version controlled values and formulas. Retain superseded proposals according to the business's document policy.

SCOPE AND CHANGE ORDER PLAYBOOK

Scope and change-order playbook

A. Scope baseline worksheet

Complete this once for each current project and update only through the approved revision process.

- Project ID:
- Customer record reference:
- Current agreement reference and revision:
- Included work summary:
- Explicit exclusions:
- Allowances and selection deadlines:
- Plans/specifications/addenda references:
- Customer-supplied items:
- Access and site assumptions:
- Schedule assumptions:
- Decision authorities recognized by the business:
- Required form or approval method:
- Change pricing method:
- Tax treatment review reference:
- Emergency make-safe policy reference:
- Internal owner:
- Last reconciled date:

B. Field change notice

This is an internal observation record, not customer authorization.

- Change-order ID and project ID:
- Date/time observed:
- Observer:
- Location:
- Observed condition, stated factually:
- Current approved scope reference:
- Why the condition may differ from scope:
- Immediate safety condition:
- Make-safe action taken, if authorized:
- Work paused or continuing under base scope:
- Photo/drawing/note evidence references:
- Customer or third-party statement, clearly attributed:
- Decision needed:
- Escalated to and time:

C. Change proposal content checklist

- Stable change-order ID and revision.
- Reference to current agreement/project.
- Existing condition or request.
- Exact added, removed, or revised scope.
- Explicit exclusions and assumptions.
- Price impact with currency and tax treatment.
- Schedule impact or not yet determined.
- Effect on prior allowances or selections.
- Expiration or decision deadline only if approved locally.
- Decision options and approved acceptance method.
- Authorized issuer identity.
- Attachments/evidence list.
- Statement that changed work is not scheduled solely by issuing the proposal, if consistent with the contract.

D. Decision record

- Change-order ID and exact revision:
- Decision: approved, declined, expired, disputed, or superseded.
- Decision date/time:
- Decision-maker identity and authority reference:
- Decision evidence reference:
- Approved amount:
- Approved schedule impact:
- Conditions attached to decision:
- Internal verifier:
- Scheduling handoff date:
- Billing handoff date:

E. Communication scripts

Condition identified; evaluation pending

Subject: Project [project reference] — condition under review

Hello [customer name],

During [verified activity], the team observed [factual condition]. We are comparing it with the current approved scope before recommending a next step. No added permanent work is authorized by this notice.

We expect to provide [an evaluation/a proposed change/no-change confirmation] by [supported date or window]. If you have a relevant document or decision-authority update, please send it through [approved route].

[Authorized sender]

Change proposal ready for review

Subject: Proposed change [change-order ID and revision] for [project reference]

Hello [customer name],

Proposed change [ID/revision] documents [verified scope summary], a price impact of [approved amount and tax statement], and a schedule impact of [approved impact or not yet determined]. Please review the attached scope, assumptions, exclusions, and decision method.

The team will treat the proposal according to the current agreement and will not infer approval from silence.

[Authorized sender]

Approved change internal handoff

Change [ID/revision] has a recorded approval reference at [secure reference]. Operations may schedule only the approved scope and revision. Amount: [approved amount]. Schedule impact: [approved impact]. Billing status: [status]. Open conditions: [verified conditions or none].

Declined or expired change internal handoff

Change [ID/revision] is [declined/expired] as of [date] with evidence at [secure reference]. Remove the proposed changed work from the active schedule unless another approved obligation applies. Preserve base-scope work and escalate any ambiguity.

F. Pre-work checklist

- Correct change ID and revision.
- Current scope comparison completed.
- Approval state verified from evidence.
- Approved amount and schedule impact match the proposal.
- Crew has the approved scope, not an obsolete draft.
- Required materials and permits confirmed.
- Safety and access conditions reviewed.
- Billing handoff owner identified.

G. Completion-to-billing checklist

- Performed work matches the approved revision.
- Completion evidence is stored.
- Deviations are separately documented.
- Approved amount reconciles to billing instruction.
- Invoice reference is recorded after actual issuance.
- Credits, disputes, or partial completion are visible.
- Customer-facing statement uses actual invoice and contract facts.

VERSION LICENSE SUPPORT

Version, license, support, and disclosure

- Product: Scope and Change-Order Control Pack
- Product ID: RR-CO-001
- Edition: 1.0.0 source edition
- Working brand: RivetRelay (provisional; pending owner/legal/marketplace clearance)

Version notes

Version 1.0.0 defines scope-baseline, field-notice, proposed-change, decision, completion, and billing-handoff records. It includes four customer/internal communication patterns, four spreadsheet formulas, controlled status rules, and six fictional lifecycle examples.

Permitted-use license

After authorized purchase, the purchaser may copy, edit, print, and use these files for the internal operations of one legal business and its personnel. The purchaser may populate the tools with its own project data and produce customer-specific change documents after independent review against its agreements and local requirements.

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Limitations

This pack is an editable operational aid, not legal, tax, accounting, engineering, safety, or contract advice. It does not determine whether a change is enforceable, whether electronic acceptance is sufficient, who has authority, what tax applies, or when emergency work may proceed. It does not guarantee approval, payment, margin, schedule recovery, or dispute prevention. The purchaser must obtain qualified review and adapt the materials to its agreements, jurisdiction, safety program, and actual facts.

Support instructions

The final storefront listing must provide the owner-approved support address and response window before publication. Support covers missing or unreadable delivered files and clarification of included field definitions. It excludes contract drafting, legal interpretation, tax treatment, claims advice, custom software integration, and project-specific decisions. Never send agreements containing sensitive data, credentials, payment information, access codes, or full customer files in a support request.

Pre-publication support route: not yet active. Publication must fail closed until the approved support route is inserted.

AI-assistance disclosure

This edition was developed with generative-AI-assisted drafting under directed product-development controls. It contains original product-specific structure and language and uses fictional examples; it does not incorporate customer contracts or third-party templates. The publisher must complete a final human publication, accuracy, licensing, legal-boundary, and file-integrity review before sale. Users must review every customer-facing document before issue.